

Security Watch

Browser Vulnerabilities

Vulnerabilities have been discovered in both Internet Explorer 6.x (as well as other versions) and Firefox.

Internet Explorer

A description of the vulnerability is very technical, but it has something to do with ActiveX controls. It can be exploited by malicious people to compromise a user's system, and run arbitrary code. In other words, your computer could be taken over. Microsoft hadn't released a patch at the time of writing. In the meanwhile, only allow trusted Web sites to run ActiveX controls. To restrict the running of ActiveX controls, open Internet Properties in the Control Panel. Under the Security tab, click on Internet (the globe icon), then select "Custom Level", and set it to High. This simply disables ActiveX. For more functionality, you could set it to Medium-High, so you'll be prompted before some ActiveX controls are run.

Better still, you could switch to Firefox!

Firefox

Mid-September, Mozilla brought out a new version of Firefox—1.5.0.7—to mend at least seven security holes, including at least four flaws that could be used to install software on vulnerable computers. If you've been regularly updating Firefox, you're using version 1.5.x. You don't need to do anything, really—Firefox will update itself if you have the option for this checked. Otherwise, simply go to **Help > Check For Updates**, and follow the instructions.

doesn't find a place here, but what we can say is that you *should* try Live search. Naturally, it's goofy at times and bang on at times, and there are hundreds of bloggers out there convinced one way or the other. We'd advise you to pay no heed to what anyone else says, and try it out for yourself. We don't think this will be a Google buster, though.

TAPPING INTO MOBILE SEARCH

The New Search Wars?

There are several reasons cited for mobile search being different from desktop search, and why search on mobiles needs to be designed differently. The mobile user is typically impatient. The screen and keypad are small. Such a user hates waiting for answers—and will not be willing to wade through screen after screen to find the search result he wants.

Consider the facts: keying in data is harder. Pointing and clicking is harder. Limited screen space means it's harder to offer different options and interpretations of the query string. On top of this, there are several device types, and optimising the user interface is therefore difficult. And then consider

the fact that the very content that mobile users want is, on the average, different from what desktop searchers are looking for, and you have a problem.

There's a lot of content out there for mobile users—news, video, weather reports, and such—and not good enough ways to access it. What's happening now is that the usual big players—Google and Yahoo!—as well as a whole bunch of start-ups such as InfoSpace, JumpTap and Medio, are getting into the mobile search fray. Search-based advertising is being experimented with.

Major Internet companies are revving up new services designed to encourage marketers to buy text ads on mobiles. For instance, Yahoo! recently struck a deal with mobile services provider Bango, designed to make it easier for businesses to buy paid search listings on cell phones.

The story actually begins here: mobile operators' revenue from voice services is on the decline, and they are counting on such things as mobile video and music downloads to make up for the lost revenue. And here comes the big catch: most wireless subscribers have hardly downloaded content or even surfed the Net from their phones looking for content. The Yankee Group estimates that only 18 per cent of

HOT Cheaper GPUs



Pixel pipelines are soaring; processing power is skyrocketing; games are getting prettier; manufacturers are outdoing each other to reduce prices like crazy—seems like there was never a better time to go out and get one...

No Futureproofing

NOT



If you go out and buy a graphics card today, you will get amazing processing power, but none of them will work with DirectX 10, and so you cannot play any of the games that will be developed for Vista—and that's just under a year from now!

wireless users in the *United States* have even tried surfing the mobile Internet!

The problem, then, is: get them to surf, get them to search, and provide quick, relevant results that point to interesting content—preferably tailor-made for mobile.

"Surfing the mobile Internet is still hard," said Eric McCabe, vice president of marketing for JumpTap. "The wired Internet didn't really start to explode until search tools like Google made it much easier to find things online."

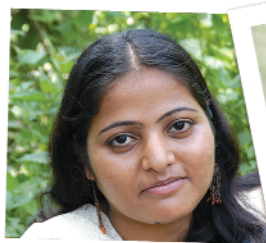
The biggest challenge for mobile search lies in building an appropriate business model. With the "regular" Web, the content

One Silly Question

"What might you trade a high-end PC for?"



"A guitar!"
Pravin Babar



"Well, a soft toy..."
Ekta Singh-Mumabi



"A floppy drive...?"
Sambhav Shrivastava



"A Discman"
Sangeetha Iyer



"How about a mobile?"
Arohi Chakraborti